

Main Document

Daala

May 2026

Founded by Sakhula & Kai

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Executive Summary

Write this last. It's the "elevator pitch" of your document.

- **The Mission:** What is the core purpose of the app?
- **The Problem:** What specific pain point are you solving?
- **The Solution:** How does your app solve it uniquely?
- **Funding Goal:** (If applicable) How much do you need and what's the projected ROI?

****The Problem: What specific pain point are you solving?**

1. Currently, South Africans struggle with severe fragmentation when looking for people who can assist them with specific tasks, often having to sift through countless disparate sources just to find one reliable person—relying heavily on word-of-mouth, broad Google searches that lack hyper-local contacts, or unstructured Facebook community posts.
2. The informal blue-collar sector is plagued by a lack of payment security, meaning people rely heavily on cash transactions in an environment where carrying physical cash presents a significant risk of theft or loss; furthermore, it introduces the friction of finding exact change, forcing customers to either blindly trust a stranger to return with their money or waste valuable time accompanying the worker to find it.
3. For the average household, finding a trusted tradesman is difficult because current channels like WhatsApp groups and Facebook lack the verifiable social proof necessary to determine a worker's experience level, their history of completed jobs, or the objective quality of their services based on past customer experiences.
4. A major pain point in our local economy is the staggering youth unemployment rate—currently exceeding 60% for those aged 15-24—leaving millions locked out of the formal economy despite societal promises that education guarantees employment, a disillusionment that ultimately drives many toward substance abuse and crime to cope with their lack of economic mobility.
5. Homeowners and minimalists often want to do simple DIY repairs, but they face the dual barrier of lacking specific, hyper-local visual guides for minor fixes and not owning the necessary tools for rare, one-off tasks; this barrier extends beyond hobbyists to skilled workers who possess the technical knowledge but lack the physical equipment to execute jobs for others.

****The Solution: How does your app solve it uniquely?**

1. Grootman solves this by offering a hyper-local, two-sided gig marketplace that combines geolocation routing with... *(Expand on the immediate visibility of workers)*.
2. We bridge the local trust gap through strict identity verification and a dual-sided review and rating system, ensuring both customers and workers can transact with confidence; by restricting reviews strictly to completed in-app transactions, we guarantee absolute credibility while simultaneously incentivizing workers to drive their offline network onto the platform to build their digital reputation.
3. Our platform uniquely provides an escrow payment infrastructure, ensuring that both

the worker's labor and the customer's capital are fully protected the moment a task agreement begins, instantly establishing trust between strangers looking to do business together.

4. By combining service booking with a content monetization engine, we allow workers to generate additional income using their existing skills by selling detailed video tutorials directly from their profiles, opening up entirely new revenue dimensions including brand collaborations and advertising revenue.
5. We eliminate the friction of DIY repairs by offering a peer-to-peer tool rental service that allows owners of idle equipment to safely monetize their assets; by requiring renters to accept a micro-insurance liability clause, we completely safeguard both parties against damage, loss, or theft, attracting more tool owners to the ecosystem.

****Funding Goal: How much do you need and what's the projected ROI?**

1. We are initially bootstrapping the development of the platform to successfully build and launch the first minimum viable version of our app in Pretoria Central.
2. To scale our local launch, we are raising an early-stage investment round through our friends and family to finance our initial marketing campaigns.
3. This initial capital will primarily be allocated to subscribing to and purchasing the necessary software development tools and infrastructure required to build the platform, as dictated by our technical architecture.
4. Before approaching SEDA or the NYDA Grant Programme, our funding goal is to reach a specific target calculated by combining Kai's technical development requirements with the costs of our initial, affordable guerrilla marketing tactics.
5. We project reaching our break-even point by month 18 through the 5-15% commission structure applied to completed gigs and purchased video content.

Company Overview

Legal Structure: Are you an LLC, C-Corp, or sole proprietorship?

The Team: Highlight the "Human Factor." Who is building the tech? Who is handling the growth?

Vision: Where is this app in 5 years? (e.g., "The leading platform for [niche].")

South Africa's soaring unemployment rate has created a crisis of financial instability, making it increasingly difficult for many to meet their basic needs. In the absence of formal employment, millions of South Africans have turned to the informal sector to survive, trading goods and services within their communities. *Daala* aims to mobilise this sector through an intuitive platform that simplifies community-based commerce. Our vision is for *Daala* to become the definitive backbone of the South African gig economy, empowering anyone to monetise their skills and turn them into accessible, scalable entrepreneurs through a single connection.

Daala is a Pretoria-based technology startup founded in May 2026 by Sakhula Mbuyane and Kai Nell. Pusha was established to address the critical gap between raw talent in the informal sector and the digital tools required to monetise those skills effectively. Sakhula drives the company's strategic vision, focusing on marketing and user acquisition. His focus is on ensuring Daala integrates seamlessly into the existing cultural fabric of South African trade. Kai leads the technical roadmap and product design. His focus is on creating a low-barrier-to-entry interface that is optimized for local conditions, including data-light performance and intuitive UX for varied literacy levels.

Our strategy begins with local community engagement in Pretoria, providing a blueprint for sustainable nationwide growth. Unlike global gig-economy apps, Daala is designed specifically for the South African "kasi" and suburban informal economies, starting with deep-rooted community engagement in Pretoria.

Operational Scope: A two-sided gig marketplace and digital education platform targeting the informal blue-collar sector. Initial deployment is restricted to Pretoria Central to establish high supply density and operational viability prior to regional expansion. Core Objective: Digitize the informal South African trade economy, establish a secure transactional layer, and provide an income and skill-growth ladder for unemployed youth, unverified tradespeople, and established blue-collar professionals.

****Legal Structure: Are you an LLC, C-Corp, or sole proprietorship?**

1. Grootman is legally structured as a Limited Liability Partnership (LLP) to avoid the heavy paperwork, administrative burden, and high fees associated with immediately establishing an LLC or C-Corp.
2. We have chosen an LLP model initially because it allows us to maintain equal, shared control based on the funding and sweat equity we are both contributing.
3. As a registered entity in South Africa, we ensure that... *(Expand on compliance)*.
4. Our corporate structure allows us to safely secure early investment from family and friends without locking ourselves into complex, unnecessary legal commitments while the product is still in its infancy.
5. As the platform scales regionally, we intend to restructure into a formal Pty Ltd to establish the necessary corporate credibility for securing institutional funding and to legally insulate the founders' personal assets against potential liabilities.

****The Team: Highlight the "Human Factor." Who is handling what?**

1. Our technical development is led entirely by Kai, a Computer Engineering graduate who is highly knowledgeable in native software coding and scalable platform development.
2. On the growth and business strategy side, Sakhula directs the planning and execution of our market positioning, brand identity, and the targeted campaigns designed to drive people to the app.
3. Kai brings vital expertise in structuring complex database architectures and... *(Expand on his specific technical strengths)*.
4. Together, our founding team combines robust technical execution with a deep,

observational understanding of the informal township sector, allowing us to modernize it in a way that delivers undeniable value to both the worker and the customer.

5. As co-founders, we clearly divide our responsibilities: Kai handles the digital infrastructure, while Sakhula manages how the ground-level deployment and daily operations in Pretoria will be executed.

****Vision: Where is this app in 5 years?**

1. In five years, Grootman will be the leading pan-African digital infrastructure for not just informal trade labor, but an expansive marketplace encompassing any conceivable task a user might need assistance with.
2. Our ultimate vision is to construct physical studio facilities where subscribed tradespeople can access state-of-the-art recording equipment and in-house professional videographers/editors to produce high-tier educational content.
3. We envision a future where we capitalize our top workers to manufacture physical, Grootman-trusted products for public retail, fostering the creation of successful micro-businesses that will directly employ the country's youth.
4. By 2031, we aim to completely formalize the informal sector, providing workers with reliable passive income streams that empower them to fundamentally elevate their quality of life.
5. Grootman is on track to be the standard household name—the "Uber for local trades"—where anyone can seamlessly access physical or intellectual labor, learn new skills directly from platform experts, and crucially, make a living by monetizing their own goods and services.

Market Analysis

Target Audience (User Personas): Go beyond demographics. What are their *psychographics*? (e.g., "Burned-out remote workers who value 5-minute mindfulness.")

Market Size: Use the **TAM, SAM, and SOM** model:

- **TAM (Total Addressable Market):** Everyone who could ever use this.
- **SAM (Serviceable Addressable Market):** The portion of TAM within your reach.
- **SOM (Serviceable Obtainable Market):** Who you can realistically capture in year one.

SWOT Analysis: Honestly list your **Strengths, Weaknesses, Opportunities, and Threats**.

****Target Audience (User Personas): What are their psychographics?**

1. Our primary supply-side user is the 'Hustling Youth'—unemployed recent matriculants motivated by a fierce need for financial independence; specifically, we target those carrying the societal shame of poor academic results, offering them a dignified, lucrative alternative to repeating Grade 12 or attending stigmatized TVET colleges.

2. We also target the 'Established Grootman,' such as seasoned local mechanics who highly value their time and craftsmanship—ambitious professionals who refuse to be confined to a single township and seek to conquer national markets by digitally setting themselves apart from uncommitted laborers.
3. On the demand side, we cater to the 'Desperate DIYer,' a minimalist who wants to build things on weekends but feels restricted by a lack of specialized tools and localized knowledge; this includes students seeking remote technical mentorship, and stranded drivers needing a quick visual guide from a mechanic to bypass exorbitant call-out fees for minor wire fixes.
4. Another key persona is the 'Traditional Crafter,' such as elderly mat makers who want to generate income in their later years for personal goals—like buying Christmas gifts for their grandchildren—while simultaneously preserving and passing down their legacy of traditional knowledge to younger generations.
5. Psychologically, our emergency customers are driven by high anxiety and a need for immediate, vetted trust when their car breaks down en route to a critical meeting, or when a sudden burst pipe threatens massive water bills and property damage.

****Market Size (TAM, SAM, SOM)**

1. Our Total Addressable Market (TAM) encompasses the roughly 5.7 million informal workers operating across the entire country.
2. Within Gauteng, our Serviceable Addressable Market (SAM) captures approximately the 1.2 million informal workers located in the province.
3. For our year-one launch, our Serviceable Obtainable Market (SOM) explicitly targets capturing 10,000 verified workers and 50,000 active buyers within Pretoria Central.
4. Statistically, the youth unemployment crisis represents a massive labor pool, with 45.8% of youth aged 15-34 actively needing a platform like this to enter the economy.
5. We are initially focusing our resources on a hyper-dense geographic radius because it is not only our immediate operational base, but it holds a massive concentration of informal workers actively serving a dense, high-demand population.

****SWOT Analysis (Strengths, Weaknesses, Opportunities, Threats)**

1. Our greatest internal strength is our built-in escrow payment security combined with a proprietary video monetization engine; unlike YouTube or Udemy, which ignore hyper-local contexts, our platform guarantees local workers are paid for every tutorial purchased, creating an unprecedented value loop.
2. A key weakness we must manage early on is our initial capital constraints and our reliance on the varying digital literacy levels of older informal workers, many of whom utilize basic feature phones and struggle with smartphone navigation.
3. The market presents a massive opportunity in securing B2B hardware partnerships, facilitating direct ambassadorships where our top workers market specific supplier products (e.g., Teknosa) using their platform credibility to drive mutual revenue.
4. A significant external threat is 'platform leakage,' where users might initially connect via the app but subsequently arrange cash transactions offline to evade commission fees.

5. We will mitigate this threat by implementing a strict Grootman Guarantee—an insurance and dispute resolution system that protects both parties, but explicitly voids all protections and mediation if the transaction occurs outside the application.

Product & Tech Stack

Daala is a two-sided gig marketplace and operates as a unified, single-application ecosystem available on both Android and iOS, with a lightweight website for SEO. A user can be categorised into one of 2 groups: **merchant/seller** or **consumer/buyer**. A merchant is a user who primarily sells their services, while the consumer buys those services. The motivation for a unified application is to encourage users to make use of both sides of the marketplace, and blur the line between buyer and seller. We are promoting a collaborative ecosystem where community members naturally cycle between providing a service and supporting another. This creates a sustainable, self-reliant marketplace where everyone contributes to, and benefits from, local economic growth. It's about creating a culture where everyone gives back to the community that sustains them.

The Minimum Viable Product (MVP)

During the initial launch phase, overcoming user skepticism—particularly regarding financial transactions—is our primary hurdle. To drive adoption, trust must be deliberately engineered into the user experience. The Daala ecosystem hinges on trust:

1. **Consumers** must trust strangers to deliver quality work.
2. **Merchants** must be reliable and actually show up.
3. **Both parties** need absolute peace of mind that compensation is secure and guaranteed.

Furthermore, capturing the South African informal sector requires a platform built for local realities. Daala is designed from the ground up to be highly accessible, data-light (cost-effective for the user), and scalable.

To achieve this balance of trust and efficiency, our MVP will launch with the following core features:

- **Gig Posting Wizard:** While Daala operates as a free marketplace with minimal restrictions on the types of gigs users can list, we provide structured guidance to help them maximize their visibility and appeal to prospective buyers. To ensure high-quality listings, core parameters such as the job title, description, budget, date, and location are collected. Depending on the selected service category (e.g., plumber, electrician, gardener, tutor), category-specific information is captured; for example, whether tools are supplied for the gardener, or the subjects offered by the tutor. A gig listing can be created by a merchant which is defined as a **Gig Post**. A different wizard allows the user to create a **Gig Request**, which is a type of gig listing created by the consumer to post a gig that needs to be fulfilled by a merchant. The MVP will launch with a limited number of standardized categories to optimize the guided listing wizard. However, to maintain an open-market ecosystem, a flexible 'Other/Custom' category will be supported. This allows for maximum market penetration while capturing user-generated data to identify future category

expansion paths.

- **Gig Management:** To accommodate different purchasing behaviors, gigs are managed through a centralised, real-time dashboard that tracks the entire lifecycle of a gig from creation to completion. This interface provides users with complete transparency and management capabilities, displaying active gig listings and their current operational status, incoming and outgoing offers or enquiries, and essential transactional updates (e.g., booking confirmation, work in progress, payment escrow status, and completion). The platform supports two distinct transaction models:
 - ◆ **Gig Requests** (Buyer-Led): A consumer posts a specific task they need completed (e.g., “*Leaking water pipe*”). Local merchants can browse these requests and submit competitive offers for the buyer to review and select via a bidding system.
 - ◆ **Gig Posts** (Merchant-Led): A merchant advertises their specific skills or services (e.g., “*Affordable mathematics tutoring*”). Prospective buyers can directly enquire, or book the service.
- **Escrow Payments:** To mitigate financial risk, eliminate payment disputes, and build absolute trust between strangers, Daala enforces a secure, automated escrow protocol across both types of gig listings. The moment an agreement is locked in—either by a buyer accepting a merchant's offer on a *Gig Request* or booking a merchant's service on a *Gig Post*—the required funds are instantly moved from the buyer's digital wallet into a secure third-party holding account (escrow). The funds remain securely held by the platform while the merchant carries out the work, providing the merchant with peace of mind that payment is guaranteed upon completion. Once the job is finished, the buyer marks the gig as complete on their dashboard. This action immediately triggers the automated release of the escrowed funds directly into the merchant's wallet. To safeguard the integrity of the escrow system and ensure absolute fairness, Daala implements a transparent dispute resolution framework backed by objective evidence. Upon finishing a task, merchants and buyers are encouraged to upload photographic evidence directly through the app to document the completed work. If a buyer is unsatisfied with the delivery or a dispute arises, they can log a formal dispute, which freezes the escrowed funds. Once a dispute is triggered, Daala's dedicated support team reviews the project timeline, communication logs, and uploaded photographic proof. Based on this objective assessment, an administrative decision is made to either release the funds to the merchant, refund the buyer, or split the payout proportionally. By introducing this impartial arbitration process, Daala provides an ultimate safety net, ensuring that honest merchants are paid for their labor and buyers are protected against subpar service.
- **Real-Time Messaging:** A clean, reliable text-chat interface allows for users to connect and discuss gigs, and the logistics thereof.
- **Media Content Posting:** A key competitive differentiator for Daala is the integration of native rich media within user profiles. Recognizing that visual proof drives consumer confidence far better than text alone, the platform empowers users to fully curate their digital presence through high-impact media galleries. Merchants can upload photos and high-definition short videos directly to a dedicated portfolio

section on their profile, or gig posts. This feature allows a gardener to showcase "before-and-after" transformations, an electrician to display tidy wiring setups, or a tutor to upload introductory videos. Consumers can post pictures of what they need "fixing" in a gig request. By transforming standard profiles into dynamic, visual resumes, Daala enables everyday informal workers to market their skills with professional-grade polish, dramatically increasing their conversion rates and credibility in the open market.

- **Mapping:** Daala integrates an interactive, map-based discovery interface. This feature enables users to instantly visualise service demand and availability within their immediate vicinity. The platform displays live gig listings directly on a localized map of the user's surrounding area. This spatial awareness allows local operators to identify nearby jobs instantly, significantly cutting down on transit expenses and logistics. To prevent interface clutter and streamline browsing, users can apply robust category filters (such as plumbing, gardening, or tutoring). This ensures that a merchant only sees opportunities perfectly matched to their trade, while a buyer can seamlessly locate relevant, nearby service providers.
- **Safety:** In order to build a culture of trust amongst merchants and buyers alike, Daala has a double rating system. After the completion of a gig, both users are encouraged to review each other, with the reviews made publicly and anonymously available on each user's profile. The user is prompted to leave a 5-star rating, with optional fields for a text comment and image upload. To proactively guard against malicious actors, the platform integrates two critical safety layers:
 - ◆ Users can flag and report suspicious profiles or illegitimate gig listings directly to Daala's support team for rapid intervention and removal.
 - ◆ Users are actively prompted to upload their official South African ID documents during the onboarding process. Once verified, a profile verification badge is unlocked, providing transparent, institutional-grade assurance that the user is exactly who they claim to be.

Technical Infrastructure

To maximise development efficiency and ensure accessibility across a wide range of devices in South Africa, Daala will launch with the following architecture:

- **Frontend:** Flutter is chosen as the UI framework for Daala. Flutter is an open-source UI software development kit created by Google and allows for simultaneous deployment on both Android and iOS platforms, cutting development time and costs nearly in half. Flutter allows for precise control over rendering of UI and data-heavy components, which enables Daala to be fast, responsive, and highly cost-effective for users operating on strict mobile data budgets. This technical efficiency ensures that Daala remains accessible to our core demographic in the informal sector, even on entry-level smartphones or under volatile network conditions. Moreover, Flutter offers exceptional backward compatibility with legacy operating systems compared to alternative UI frameworks. This allows Daala to run smoothly on older and entry-level smartphones without sacrificing performance or

visual clarity. By optimising for lower-spec hardware, we successfully lower the barrier to entry, ensuring that our platform remains accessible to the widest possible demographic across South African communities.

→ **Backend/Database:** [Firebase](#) is Google's development suite providing ready-made backend services, such as databases, authentication, and cloud storage. By leveraging Firebase's suite of pre-built serverless modules, we completely eliminate the need to architect a complex server infrastructure from scratch. This decision dramatically reduces the initial engineering costs and compresses the timeline to launch, allowing our focus to remain entirely on front-end user experience and marketplace features. Firebase's flexible, pay-as-you-go pricing model allows Daala to scale organically alongside user adoption. This eliminates the heavy overhead costs traditionally associated with setting up, maintaining, and continuously re-engineering custom cloud server infrastructure.

→ **APIs & Integrations:**

- ◆ **Payment System:** Daala is not a financial service provider (FSP). According to the National Payment System (NPS) Act of 1998 and the Banks Act of 1990 (South Africa), Daala may not operate an unlicensed payment system, hold customer funds as an unregulated entity, or independently move funds between two users outside regulated rail. For this reason, an authorised payment service provider must be used to facilitate end-to-end transactions amongst users. [TradeSafe](#) is an authorised Third-Party Payment Provider and specialises in multi-party wallet and escrow systems. TradeSafe solves for the requirements of a digital wallet mechanism, and holding user funds until a gig has been completed (escrow). TradeSafe allows Pusha to function legally as a neutral venue while TradeSafe handles the heavy regulatory lifting of holding other people's money.
- ◆ **Geolocation & Mapping:** [Google Maps Platform](#) is the industry standard and will be used for physical address validation, map rendering, and distance calculations.
- ◆ **KYC & FICA Compliance:** While Daala is not classified as an accountable institution under the Financial Intelligence Centre Act (FICA), our integrated escrow partner—TradeSafe—is a strictly regulated entity. To combat financial crimes such as money laundering, fraud, tax evasion, and terrorist financing, TradeSafe must enforce rigorous client verification and transaction monitoring. To interface seamlessly with TradeSafe and guarantee the legal processing of funds, Daala securely collects and transmits the following verified data points for every transaction: user's full legal names and verified email address, South African ID number or formal Business Registration number, verified cell phone number, and valid bank account details for wallet withdrawals. To facilitate this data collection without disrupting the user

experience, Daala implements an automated Know Your Customer (KYC) framework powered by [VerifyNow](#). Integrating VerifyNow allows us to perform real-time, frictionless identity checks directly within the application. Furthermore, because Daala processes sensitive Personal Identifiable Information (PII)—including South African ID numbers, live biometrics, and banking information—our technical architecture strictly adheres to the Protection of Personal Information Act (POPIA). All data transmitted between the Flutter frontend, VerifyNow, and TradeSafe is encrypted in transit using SSL/TLS protocols and encrypted at rest within our database environments. No banking credentials or official ID documents are stored locally on the user's device, and strict data-retention policies ensure that account deletion triggers an automated cryptographic wipe of user PII from our cloud instances.

- ◆ **System Monitoring:** To maintain high platform uptime and trust within the informal economy, Daala integrates [Firebase Crashlytics](#) and [Sentry](#). This allows us to monitor application performance in real time, capturing and debugging frontend crashes or API integration failures silently before they impact the end-user experience.

Future Features & Scaling

1. Future iterations on our roadmap will introduce the gamified Level 1 to Level 5 skill progression, where workers earn XP for completing gigs and unlock specific package benefits—culminating in a Platinum tier that drastically reduces platform commission fees on their labor and content.
2. We have intentionally delayed the peer-to-peer tool rental ecosystem until we can fully integrate micro-insurance partnerships, ensuring renters avoid exorbitant replacement costs and granting owners total peace of mind to safely rent out their equipment.
3. Later phases will also deploy paid full-length video courses priced between R29 and R79, alongside interactive Live Classes where workers stream their on-site jobs in real-time, explaining their methodologies directly to paying students.
- 4.

Marketing & User Acquisition

ASO (App Store Optimization): How will you rank for keywords?

Viral Loops: Does the app encourage users to invite friends?

Content Strategy: Will you use TikTok/Reels, SEO blogs, or influencer partnerships?

****Viral Loops: Encouraging invites.**

1. The app naturally encourages sharing when workers push their offline customers to book exclusively through the platform in order to aggressively build their completed job metrics and public review count.
2. We will incentivize workers to invite their existing network by offering a "Refer a Pro" feature that distributes discount codes to non-users for their first gig, driving new customer acquisition through the worker's existing reputation.
3. A key viral mechanic is the "Top Build" weekly competition, where winning workers receive exclusive perks and custom-designed, branded digital posters to share across their personal social media, organically extending our brand reach.
4. When a customer leaves a 5-star review, the system automatically prompts them to seamlessly broadcast the worker's profile across major social networks like Instagram, WhatsApp, Twitter, and Facebook.
5. The peer-to-peer tool rental system inherently creates a viral loop because users must actively invite friends to collaborate and work together on their weekend DIY projects.

****Content Strategy: Social media and partnerships.**

1. Our guerrilla marketing relies heavily on hyper-local community integration, such as targeting taverns and Spaza shops, and orchestrating public "Easter egg hunts" where users are incentivized to photograph our masked mascot in the wild and post it on social media using official brand hashtags.
2. We will leverage TikTok and Instagram Reels by matching real, non-AI DIY footage to trending audio, while deliberately avoiding the trap of simply chasing corporate trends in favor of engineering our own culturally resonant viral moments.
3. A core visual identifier will be the 'Grootman' Luchador mask—worn during public stunts and free repair giveaways; this mascot will operate as a living, breathing entity tied directly to the brand, building intense mystery and deep brand recognition.
4. Local influencer partnerships will involve supplying top hand-skilled South Africans on Facebook with branded merchandise for their content, and outfitting their physical workshops with unique smartphone-silhouette posters containing QR codes that drive foot traffic straight to their digital profiles.
5. During high-anxiety periods like Matric results release, we will run campaigns that deliberately offer hope, presenting Grootman as a viable, dignified alternative path for youth to build a prosperous life despite poor academic marks.

Monetisation Strategy

How will you actually make money? Common models include:

- **Freemium:** Basic features are free; "Pro" features require a subscription.
- **In-App Purchases:** Digital goods or one-time feature unlocks.

- **Subscription (SaaS):** Monthly/Annual recurring revenue (the investor favorite).
- **Ad-Based:** Selling attention (requires high volume).

****How will you actually make money?**

1. Our primary revenue stream is a transactional commission model, where we deduct 15% from the initial escrow upon job completion, dynamically decreasing this fee for recurring call-outs between the same worker and customer to heavily discourage offline platform leakage.
2. To rapidly acquire supply, we will initially offer a freemium model for workers, meaning they pay zero commission for their first batch of completed gigs, acting as a "free trial" hook that proves our value before we transition them to the standard commission rate.
3. We generate direct content revenue by facilitating the sale of premium tutorial videos and courses priced at the worker's discretion, utilizing our platform analytics to advise them on optimal pricing strategies to maximize their sales volume.
4. Our buyer subscription tier will generate Monthly Recurring Revenue (MRR) by offering perks such as heavily discounted call-out fees and a monthly allocation of no-cost VIP or late-night emergency gig requests.
5. In the future, the peer-to-peer tool rental marketplace will open a new revenue channel by applying a standard commission cut to the hourly rental rate, successfully funding the maintenance and micro-insurance of that specific ecosystem.

Operational Plan

Timeline

TASK	MONTH 1				MONTH 2				MONTH 3				MONTH 4				MONTH 5				LAUNCH	MONTH 6				MONTH 7				MONTH 8			
	1	2	3	4	1	2	3	4	1	2	3	4	1	2	3	4	1	2	3	4		1	2	3	4	1	2	3	4	1	2	3	4
App Development																																	
Frontend Design																																	
Auth & Onboarding																																	
Gig Mechanics																																	
Messaging & Media																																	
Map API integration																																	
TradeSafe API integration																																	
KYC & Safety																																	
Quality Assurance & Submission																																	
Business & Marketing																																	
Community Outreach																																	
Park																																	
Social Media																																	

Fixed

Item	Description	Estimated Cost (Month)
App Signing	Apple Developer Account: \$99 (~R1,800) per year	R150
Domain Registration	Daala.co.za (R178 per year)	R15
Google Workspace	Professional email addresses and business accounts (e.g. help@daala.co.za) <i>Business Starter Account</i>	R115
Total		R280

Variable

As userbase grows.

Item	Description	Estimated Cost
VerifyNow	ID + Photo verification <i>Once-off onboarding</i>	R25-R45/per user
TradeSafe	Standard Fee: 1.5% of total transaction value Visa surcharge: 2.5% of total transaction value EFT surcharge: 0.75% of total transaction value Ozow surcharge: 1.5% of total transaction value	~2% of txn value
OTP SMS Authentication	<i>Once-off onboarding</i>	R 0.35 per SMS
Google Maps API	Address auto-complete	R275/1000 calls
Google Maps API	Geocoding (maps) R3,200 free credit per month	R80/1000 calls
Firebase Egress Bandwidth	10 GB free per month	R1.92/GB

Firebase Cloud Functions	2M free runs per month	R6.40/1M runs
Firebase Cloud Storage	5GB free	R0.42/GB
Firebase OAuth	First 10,000 users free	R0.088/user
Firestore Reads	1.5M reads free per month	R0.96/100K
Firestore Writes	600K writes free per month	R2.88/100K
Total		

* Firebase free-tier allowances are generous and will fully cover the platform during early-stage operation. Billable costs only materialise once user volumes and activity exceed the stated thresholds.

* Google Maps API costs can be reduced through selective caching of geocoding and Places results, avoiding redundant API calls for frequently queried locations.

Projected Revenue

Rough Work

Rough Work

SERIOUS QUESTIONS TO ANSWER

Phase 1: South African Structural Obstacles

- **Financial Compliance:** How will the platform legally hold and clear third-party escrow funds under FICA and FSCA regulations without creating severe operational or onboarding bottlenecks for the corporate structure?
- **Data Cost Friction:** What specific video compression, adaptive bitrate streaming, and localized caching mechanisms will be engineered into the architecture to prevent video reels and tutorials from exhausting the target demographic's expensive mobile data?
- **KYC vs. Supply Liquidity:** How will the platform accurately verify the identities of informal workers who lack formal documentation, proof of residence, or traditional banking infrastructure without stalling the supply-side onboarding pipeline?
- **Asset Security:** What risk mitigation and asset recovery protocols will protect tool owners from theft in the peer-to-peer rental ecosystem without enforcing restrictive credit vetting that excludes the target demographic?
- **Platform Leakage:** How will the platform prevent users from bypassing the digital gateway and taking recurring transactions offline to cash once the initial connection is established?
- **Physical Safety:** What real-time security and dispatch protocols will protect workers and consumers in unvetted environments without the platform incurring employer liability?

Phase 2: Sector-Specific Transactional Gaps

- **Monetization Mechanics:** How will the platform structure its transactional flow to guarantee that workers incur zero upfront costs and only pay a fee upon successful escrow clearance?
- **Value Metric Modulation:** How will the user interface explicitly condition consumers to select workers based on visual skill portfolios rather than forcing a race-to-the-bottom price war?
- **Fee Transparency:** How will the platform maintain a clean, single-sided take-rate that avoids the dual-fee "double-dipping" models that cause user resentment on competing platforms?
- **Dispute Arbitration:** What objective, human-backed mediation framework will the platform enforce to resolve property damage or abandoned jobs instead of abdicating legal liability to the users?

Phase 3: Internal Operational & Growth Gaps

- **Hyper-Local Density:** What strict geographical boundaries will be enforced to ensure absolute supply-demand liquidity within Pretoria Central before attempting broader regional scaling?
- **Retaining Supply:** What continuous software utility, financial tools, or community status will be provided to top-tier artisans to make platform defection mathematically disadvantageous?

- **Engagement Frequency:** How will the video and educational engine successfully transform a low-frequency utility application (emergency repairs) into a daily, habitual consumer opening routine?
- **Labor Autonomy:** How will the matching algorithm protect the pricing power and autonomy of highly skilled workers from being compressed by lower-tier, unverified labor?
- **Automated Vetting:** What third-party verification APIs will handle automated, high-velocity background and identity screening from day one to avoid manual operational scaling bottlenecks?

Phase 4: Market Validation Gates

- **Escrow Trust Validation:** How will you empirically test if a consumer is willing to deposit capital upfront into a digital holding account before an unvetted worker arrives at their private residence?
- **Visual Premium Validation:** How will you prove through initial user data that a consumer will willingly choose to pay a premium price for an artisan with a video portfolio over a cheaper option without one?
- **Supply-Side Network Loop:** Will top-tier workers mandate that their existing offline clients transition onto the application to build their digital review counts and reputation?

List the things that stood out from the Marketplace Handbook

RANDOM

“Don't ask the people who don't use your product why they don't use your product, instead ask the people who KEEP using your product why they keep on using it”. - from Instagram founders, on How I Built This podcast, quoting Eric Ries (Lean Startup book author)

What can the platform offer to make people post about workers who don't use our app. This includes workers who don't have a smartphone because of finance and/or too old to understand using one? Some of these workers don't want to be monitored because they may be scamming/committing fraud to people. A legal way which gives a customer, who may also not be registered in our platform to let others know of a worker they dealt with, be it positive or negative. A forum of some sort. Should it be one single chat box (just like a WhatsApp group) where everyone can post or should it be organised by areas (just like 1 on 1 chats on WhatsApp)? The former would be easier and quicker to build but the customer would be overwhelmed knowing everybody from everywhere is posting on this chat, having to specify where they are from before posting, and having a search box.

What is holding companies from tapping into the informal market which billions pass through it per year

look at airtaskers current problems mentioned by customers

Remove friction by allowing people to set up the measurements of their houses and types of cars they own so when they select a home gig like gardening they dont have to constantly fill in the same details or when hiring a mechanic it automatically auto fills their version and car specific details

How do you incentivize users to keep on using different workers and not the same worker every single time?

Strategies to get people on it and using it

- Offer to provide workers with photographers who will shoot content for them. The way this contract can be set up is that they dont pay upfront the costs of the photographer but will be charged a small additional fee, on top of our standard platforms' fee, to pay for the photographer. This gets people seeing our value in being proactive, as the platform that seeks their

Sectors our platform will infiltrate by opening them up to regular folks or help in starting something of their own:

- Funeral parlour (lol i dont know how but i just have a feeling where people will be trusted to handle a funeral and the guy who got that gig will just have to get the equipment and people for a day or two, get the job done, pay them and then look for the next gig)
- Runners
- tour/safari guiding

Customers problems that we must seek to solve for them:

- They want something done but dont have the full money to pay for it one time to the service provider. Payflex
- They dont have smartphones and internet coverage

AI Overview From Google Gemini when searching “South Africa informal economy size”

South Africa's informal sector—often referred to as the "hidden" economy or "kasinomics"—is a massive economic engine. It accounts for **19.5% of total employment (roughly 3 million non-agricultural jobs)**, and generates between R900 billion and R2.5 trillion annually, contributing roughly **5% to 12% of the country's GDP.** [1, 2, 3, 4]

The sheer size and impact of the sector can be broken down into these core areas:

- **Employment:** The informal economy is the second-largest source of jobs in South Africa after the formal sector. When including agricultural and survivalist roles, estimates suggest the sector provides income for up to 7.8 million people. [1, 2, 3]
- **Economic Value:** Recent estimates value the "hidden" economy at around R900 billion, with annual turnovers across micro-enterprises ranging from R100,000 to R50 million. [1]
- **Industry Breakdown:** The sector is dominated by the trade and service industries. This includes spaza shops, taverns (shebeens), minibus taxis, street hawking, and household services. [1, 2, 3, 4]
- **Survival vs. Scale:** Approximately 80% of informal businesses are unregistered, making it difficult for operators to access formal banking, capital, or loans. However, the sector functions as a vital poverty-alleviation mechanism and an active consumer market. [1, 2, 3]

Names:

1. Grootman. The mascot could be called Grootman. He could also have a humorous ad in the future briefly talking about how he was “born”, his parents being GrootPa and GrootMa, and his parent's home being our headquarters which during the time he is telling this story he will be “out the house trying to find himself as an independent young man” (giving a story to this character will be a good unique way to hook people into the stories of our company like what it means, who is it doing it for. Plus, the story feature is a good way to get people listening and be moved as we all know that stories and emotions move/motivate humans more than most ways out there. The character will give a dimension to the brand that is really unique and unheard of in the business world and marketing. The different tiers could also be titled Laaitie to Grootman (we have to think of the other names that also have a SAn lingo to name the other tiers in between the two i have mentioned). The challenge with this name is i haven't thought about how exactly it can be made a verb when people are thinking/telling others to use it
2. Dala. This is a word mostly used by coloureds, especially from the Cape, which means “to do”. Most SAns know it from the expression “dala what you must” which our ads/marketing could play with that expression to say Dala (use our app) to do (request) what you must (need assistance with). But also Dala is very similar to “om'dala” which is a Xhosa/Zulu word for the elders/grown ups. There's also “lom'dala” which is a commonly used slang

word, derived from “om'dala”, that is a salutation expression meaning “the respectable guy with a big stature”. But going back to “om'dala” that can also be butchered a bit by adding the letter O at the beginning which will now give it the Afrikaans flavour to mean uncle when it's now “Oom'Dala”. We can bring humour by naming the poster “Dali” which is commonly used by SAnS in a romantic manner to say “Dear/ Love”. The masked mascot could be called “om/oom'Dala”

3.

Logo (inspo):

Put out a gig on the platform for a designer to create one, or run a social media competition for designers to come up with a logo for us, and then we pick and pay the winner?

Name	App Store	Company Registration This is not critical, it is only a name for our business as a legal entity. Check names here: www.govchain.co.za	Domain Also added prices. Check domains here: porkbun.com – there are hundreds of domains, unfortunately most of the time .com will be taken. I added what I think would work. Can also use other sites if needed.
Dala	App Store: ☒ No 'Dala' apps Play Store: ☒ Dala - low downloads/reviews (low risk)	☒ 'Dala' is taken ☒ 'Dala Now' ☒ 'DalaNow' ☒ 'DalaSA' ☒ 'DalaTech'	☒ dala.now - \$19.50/year ☒ dala.tech - \$273.44/year
Yenza	App Store: ☒ Play Store: ☒	☒ 'Yenza' ☒ 'Yenza inc' ☒ 'Yenza SA' ☒ 'YenzaNow'	☒ yenza.tech - \$6.99/year ☒ yenza.inc - \$257.98/year ☒ yenza.now - \$19.05/year ☒ yenza.one - \$2.57/year ☒ yenza.to - \$51.80/year
Nuvo	App Store: ☒ Play Store: ☒ Quite a few apps that users may confuse with ours		
Kago	App Store: ☒ Another app exists Play Store: ☒ Another app exists		

Vira	App Store: Too many similar apps Play Store: Too many similar apps		
Tuma	App Store: Play Store: Only one similar app and it uses 'Tuma250'	'Tuma' 'Tuma Innovations' 'TumaSA' 'TumaNow'	tuma.one - \$2.54/year tuma.now - \$19.05/year tuma.tech - \$136.98/year
Kaza	App Store: One similar app , but it's clearly arabic so it might not be a problem Play Store: Also some similar apps , but seems mostly arabic looking apps so if our branding is distinct, it shouldn't be a problem.	'Kaza' 'Kaza Tech' 'KazaTech' 'KazaNow'	kaza.tech - \$273.44/year kaza.com - \$75,000/year kaza.now - \$19.05/year kaza.one - \$2.57/year

The Three Pricing Models (need to discuss)

1. The Seller-Pays Model (Deduction)

In this model, the listed price is exactly what the buyer pays, and your 15% commission is deducted from the seller's earnings.

- **The Math:** * **Buyer Pays:** R250.00
 - **Marketplace Fee (15%):** R37.50
 - **Seller Receives:** R212.50
- **Pros:** Highly attractive to buyers. The price they see browsing is the price they pay at checkout, which maximizes conversion rates.
- **Cons:** Sellers feel the "squeeze." To compensate, sellers will often organically raise their base prices (e.g., listing a R250 service at R300) to ensure they still clear their desired profit.

2. The Buyer-Pays Model (Addition)

In this model, the seller keeps their full R250, and your 15% commission is added on top as a "service fee" paid by the buyer.

- **The Math:**
 - **Seller Receives:** R250.00
 - **Marketplace Fee (15%):** R37.50
 - **Buyer Pays:** R287.50
- **Pros:** Highly attractive to sellers. It is incredibly easy to onboard supply because they know they get exactly what they ask for.

- **Cons:** It penalizes the buyer. If not handled correctly, it can lead to sticker shock and abandoned carts.

3. The Split Model (Alternative)

Many modern marketplaces (like Airbnb or Fiverr) split the fee to make it less painful for both sides. For example, you could take 10% from the seller and charge a 5% service fee to the buyer.

- **The Math:**
 - **Listed Price:** R250.00
 - **Buyer Pays (Base + 5%):** R262.50
 - **Seller Receives (Base - 10%):** R225.00
 - **Marketplace Keeps:** R37.50



Books

Blue Ocean Strategy

going to close industries and attracting non-customers, e.g:

- *Amazon went from selling books to selling everything in retail. they also went into cloud hosting with AWS
- *Apple went from laptops to all the other personal computers like mp3players, smartphones and ipads

Eliminate, Raise, Reduce, Create (section)

A flicker/spark of a blue ocean: why do you have to email an artist and then find out through private talks how much they charge when they could just list their price on our platform (the artists can choose if the price is negotiable or not) this makes it easier for people who want to create events to know how much a particular artist charges to know if they should hire them or not. Lets remove mentality when it comes to people listing their price. We will also be removing the friction of these artists getting gigs from the average citizens because sometimes we want to know how much they charge but knowing the whole process of searching for their email, getting in contact with their managers, and asking the price may be something worth not doing for most people because some first want to know the price first before committing and also not wanting to look like they are playing with these artists management teams time if they choose to not go through with it

Formulating Blue Ocean Strategy

Across industries e.g different modes of transportation. (What other close industries can you find customers?)

- Runners/ Couriers
- Field Guides
- Taxi industry/ Uber/ e-hailing/ buses
- Personal Trainers (rather than paying a monthly subscription, you can hire them for one day at your gym)

Within industries e.g expensive/luxury options vs affordable options (how many vertical levels of customers from budget friendly to luxury/expensive does the market we are dealing in have?)

- Luxury car detailers vs average car detailers

Chain of buyers e.g distributor/influencer vs direct customer. (Who are/ can be our customers/users?)

- Mechanic vs the car owner vs the car dealer for 2nd hand cars vs spare shops where parts for cars are sold vs brands/companies of these car parts
- Gardener vs homeowner vs warehouse shop where you find gardening tools vs brands/companies of the gardening tools

Across complementary product and service offerings (what happens before, during, and after your product is used?)

- They need a smartphone to use the platform
- Internet connection
- Paid Videos buy skilled individuals sharing their knowledge for DIY-ers and...(point below)
- Tool hiring feature (this caters to people who want to do it themselves but dont have the tools to do so)

Look Across *Functional or Emotional appeal to Buyers* (has the industry set the standard to be functional for buyers, if so can you change it and appeal to the emotional side of it? Or vice versa)

- How can you get users to attach an appeal that isnt the standard metric of making a purchase in that industry. Car washers are judged by how clean they can wash a car, thats functional and every business and customers that go into that industry use that as a standard. How do you then offer an emotional appeal to it? Gifting/ special days like birthdays, weddings etc; attaching it to a holiday
- Example: A kitchen renovator cooking dinner for her clients' new kitchen and having it with them. It creates an emotional appeal to something that has a functional standard



Marketing

“Put your money where your mouth is” - this is what we should always remember when doing things for the business which will also make people see that we are walking the talk where we hire people to do anything— if not everything— that can be done by posting a gig, meant for the business, on the platform where anybody with the skills can take it and then we can also tag them on our social media pages using links to their profiles. This will also differentiate us from everybody else

Marketing Phases

Phase 1: 1st year(targeted demographic marketing):

Billboards and any form of public advertising (also murals) is something that's constant throughout the phases, this doesn't need to be placed in any phases and is more of creating brand familiarity and to remind people about us

- target the general public: gazebos, public stunts
- target students: freshers parties, sports events between schools
- target informal traders: approach them in person at their place of work (have the silhouettes)
- target white collar professionals who can sell their skills: contact them through LinkedIn, go to their firms or schedule in person/phone meetings
- target car owners: go on the street especially in the morning and evening when there is traffic or the parking lots of stadiums when a game is playing
- home owners: go door-to-door and do your pitch there
- businesses: go to their locations and pitch to them why they should hire workers through your app to do jobs for their business like fixing taps, or anything that doesn't need the landlord if they are leasing
- Social media platforms where users enquire for help; Facebook groups, Reddit, Quora, WhatsApp community groups

Phase 2: 2nd year (“hijacking” other events):

- marathons,
- sports/ stadium matches,
- car shows,

Phase 3: 3rd year (make your own events):

- expos,
- debate shows (Junto),
- host tool shed events where guys, most especially, can bond with each other while building something for their mental health
- awards,

Ads/ Marketing Campaign ideas

Always use real people for your videos, dont do AI. It looks cheap. —the labour illusion

ADS which will need actors, we should post the gig

The **Logo**, the **Slogan**, and the **Brand Colors**?

1. TELL STORIES ABOUT YOUR BRAND through documentaries. We, the founders, can tell it ourselves and also use the users, workers and customers, experience and the impact it has done in their lives
2. Have ads like "let's build a buggy FROM scratch with the bros" and have a course of a guy showcasing how to build one from start to finish.
3. School ads where kids are laid in bed frustrated on where they are going to get help with doing their science project.
4. Have ads of DIY projects titled "let's build a shower this weekend with Mr (name of worker using our platform)".
5. Have an ad where a "grootman       will pop up everytime a person says the word randomly talking to their friends in person and/over the phone, the Batman signal is saying the name Grootman and he'll appear.
6. Market the ad on community groups like Hazyview WhatsApp residents groups and The Reeds, and also youth groups by framing it that they can acquire a skill or build with friends to make quick cash.
7. Observe how viral DIY TikTok/ IG reels shoot their videos and edits for marketing in such platforms to gain traction from your content.

8. Collaborate with schools and use workers from the platform to teach children how to use their hands and create simple stuff.
9. Randomly go to people's houses and offer to do for them for free one thing that needs fixing in the house while you shoot and record, and then ask them to just to download the app as a payment. While the worker is fixing, you can also advertise the business to the people you're helping.
10. Give merchandise to top DIY guys, mechanics, carpenters to wear when shooting their online content.
11. Just like Vans founder doubled down on skateboarders as a niche to promote his product, let's take the same concept and apply the ferocity to informal/kasi workers.
12. During matric results time, launch an ad campaign giving hope to matriculants who didnt pass that its not the end, and if they trust in your platform they will see its just the beginning of their skilled and prosperous life.
13. Give posters with our app branding on it to the workers to place alongside their business boards/posters e.g for a plumber, give them huge posters of a phone silhouette with our branding and the plumber's icon on it or personalise it with their exact credentials on the app, so that it takes the scanner directly to that particular worker's profile on the app. So this will push people to look for them in the app, which in turn drives more traffic into it.
14. Use funny cheesy lines like "i dont walk on water because I always fix where the water is coming from" or "You ask if my mother's water broke when she had me? The water didnt have a chance!" as Ad campaigns for plumbers for example.
15. On Facebook, have somebody who is quick to comment on posts from people asking help that needs a particular tradesman.

16. Wear a luchador mask that has brand colors of the business or has a resemblance of our mascot.
17. Pay Influencers to promote the business in their content. Contact Facebook SAn handskilled people with a fair amount of following and ask them to advertise your business and be a user&ambassador of the business.
18. Have an ad where there's a bunch of images of studies, tweets, articles, newspapers, video clips of people talking about South Africa's youth unemployment rate playing on a big screen and then the camera zooms out to show Grootman Luchador watching that before he stands up and gives a motivating monologue introducing the app which will give hope to the youth.
19. Ad: an elderly lady, with glasses, seated on her couch holding her smartphone the way old people do where one hand is holding on to it and the other is the one tapping it using the index finger while the phone is held at a distance. She is busy trying to figure out how to do her taxes with the SARS mobi app but she quickly sees how complicated it is, so she then asks herself "how am I going to file my taxes?! I dont understand a thing on this app and going all the way to SARS branches for this is a lot of time and money spent. If there was only a way to find a person who is trusted and has the knowledge to do it for me for a quick buck without me moving here and continuing watching my soapie?" And that's when we introduce our platform in this ad. It can be the mascot budging in unannounced like a superhero who shows up whenever he is called no matter where the person is. [We can frame our mascot, on ads, as a superhero who his Bat-signal are average people facing problems which he(our platform) can help solve]
20. Have videos where you are enthusiastically showcasing the products of what workers have built, especially genius kitchen cupboard Carpentry or multifunctional furniture. Tell people to use our hashtag on social media to promote their handskills.
21. Holiday marketing: On Heritage day, host all the 11 official languages of SA including Khoi San. Have a video talking or doing something like eating a cuisine of that tribe trying to speak their language in their traditional clothes in their homeland. Appeal to the teenagers on holidays by having an ad campaign that says "make money during your holidays". And also tell the old folks to hire these kids so they learn how to make

money by doing community work. This also reduces the likelihood of them doing crime to make money or doing drugs because of having nothing to do

22. appear (and offer to be their sponsor in exchange for them to allow our branding in the event) in public events like marathons, run clubs, concerts, car shows etc and also try to bring brand awareness by talking with the participants there
23. have trailers of you building something with the workers (a video to promote the worker) where its in slow motion walking together in a shed/barn with cinematic color grading and shots where we are shown building the product, where different shots and scenes pop up and fade away, playing music like Life Is a Highway in the background. obviously, as our brand will be synonymously known for always covering the behind the scenes of how it planned and did its content. Hire an in-house videographer/editor
24. i dont know how we will know in time that there is a crowd of people lining up for employment opportunities like the recent viral hundreds of RocoMamas interviewees lining up outside, and then in our branding merch pitch to them and make them sign up. You can get on top of an elevated object standing in the middle of the crowd with a megaphone or your own voice and pitch to them all at once right there. Have somebody record that so we can repost it on our socials Go to Podcasts like Podcast&Chill. Remember every time there is a public marketing campaign, needing representatives of our company to be on the ground or on screen, our masked mascot has to be the one leading it
25. Shoot a video of a real couple using our platform to hire the different services needed to set up their wedding from tent guys to catering, and have a behind the scenes too so that people see these are real people and not actors
26. You are at work but then during lunch you realise your car wont start. Now you are stressed, and don't know what to do since in a few hours time you'll need it to go home. Worry not! There's our platform for that. Just post your gig on the platform, specify everything that it is time urgent because you'll need it to go home with and he will have to be willing to go buy the needed parts since you are at work. (Thats the fun part about the platform is that you can specify the requirements of the gig)

Next thing, Boom! A mechanic accepts the offer, diagnoses the car, goes and buys the parts and then he is paid for his services and extra help through the escrow

27. Go on the streets and hand out flyers to the traffic wearing the mascot mask
28. Film the firsts: first completed job, first poster, first tasker
29. Interview the guys who will be cleaning up with you on your first public campaign
30. Go around houses looking at whats commonly visible that most houses need fixing in common and then try to approach the house owners and ask them to shoot a video telling them how to fix it by easily getting someone who knows how to on our app.
31. For the students who you will be working with give them backpack branded merchandise that when used by them in school it will make others aware about our brand. What bag should it be? What type of branding should it be: logo, slogan, telling people to use our platform, should this particular one target students?
32. Content to fill up on our social media pages at the beginning?
33. Interview your users from time to time, (sometimes give giveaways) as a way of showing other people that its real people who are being helped or making a living from this platform
34. Communicate your business through stories. Tell your stories as founders for what motivated you to build this and stay the course. Make the customer the hero. Basically what Donald Miller said in his book Building a Brand Story (you should get the physical copy this time around) Dont build a company, build a human connection

35. show the behind the scenes of your campaigns, if it is a cartoon/animation ad, if it is a speech or rapping ad. Record and show the whole process in detail . Why? because you can sell/ offer for free to subscribers so we keep the brand/image/message of wanting to educate people on how to do things. Add bloopers to give humour and humanness to it
36. Host debates under the companies name. Q: What does our company have to do with debates? A: What does Outsurance have to do with guiding traffic when the traffic lights dont work? Real Answer: Brand visibilty but also associating the brand with helping the youth have constructive dialogues and ways in talking about issues that affect them
37. PR stunts where we put out gigs paid for by the company to get people signing up and doing them. Have gigs where somebody asks something to be bought for them at the shop (this can be shot where a high school kid does it to get money for lunch tomorrow. How could we respond to the safety concerns of parents letting their kids doing things for strangers? maybe have parental access for kids who are signed up on this app to make a quick buck).
38. the inside walls of taxis
39. Have an ad targeted to first time mothers. I have noticed that most people nowadays live far away from home and elders who have the knowledge on the dos and donts of newborns. So we will try to solve that by saying that we have babysitter who have a track record, provided by our app through ratings and reviews, that a particular person can be trusted to take care of your baby when at work or gone out
40. sponsor Miss SA candidate who speaks about unemployment, sponsor public personas that are concerned about unemployment or are doing something to uplift the youth whether it is out of drugs, crime or upskilling them.
41. To put our money where our mouth is most of the graphic design in our marketing promos will be designed by workers who are signed up in our platform

42. What marketing strategy can we take from successful companies and implement in our branding/marketing? (also what ads are so memorable to you?)

Red Bull is known for endorsing athletes who do extreme sports and posting their content, inserts their name and branding in the Football Clubs they purchase

Nike endorses high performing athletes and lets them create their own gear

Apple said they were creating products for misfits and creatives, and the confidence of Steve Jobs claiming they had the best product attracted people to it. Did they have a marketing deal with Hollywood?

Toyota is simply known for durability and reliability. I love their humorous ads which basically say you will never find our cars broken down on the side of the road and even if it fell off a cliff the only thing you have to worry about is YOU going down there to fetch it because wherever it is down there it is still intact

43. Ad: song Drake Gods Plan

Have the same concept of his music video of going around giving people hope (you can go to schools and make them say Grootmans Plan instead of Gods Plan) while there are other scenes showing you rapping to the song. Should you give them money, app coupons, teaching them about the app (empowering them)

44. Host EXPOS where workers who can build products can bring them to the public to look for customers and investors

45. Ad: Use the tactic of using real names and faces when talking about the unemployment statistics, just like Nayib Bukele mentioned that people take things to heart if you attach stories and names to crime statistics, for example in his case, rather than just using numbers

46. Ad: Song - Chant by Macklemore

You run through the city on some Rocky Balboa shit wearing Grootman merchandise, workers start joining in 1 by 1. A scene of dancers is shown in this video syncing together as the chorus hits, this can show togetherness and also promote choreographers who are signed up on the platform

47. Contact tiktok/IG reels editors, who can create a crazy edit for us, also showcasing how they did it step by step so we can post for free under our app. First provide something of great value for free and then watch the reciprocity principle do its thing.
48. Have the youth cleaning up the streets wearing the brand's merchandise. [How can we connect that to our brand/business? Just like Outsurance is an insurance company but chooses to help guide traffic where traffic lights aren't working so they can be associated with being helpful, plus the familiarity they create with people] We should repeat this awareness launch campaign around a selected few areas like Central, Pretoria East (which Kai mentioned to be concentrated with the middle class), universities (UP, for example, which is mainly the youth who we will be marketing to there. This also brings the question of researching if it's allowed to go in-campus and do such, sports events or will we have to do it just outside their premises where students enter and exit from):
- A. ***remember the What, Why, How framework**
 - B. Gazebo. (Take a look at this OZtrail MPG-D30B-D Gazebo on Makro https://www.makro.co.za/oztrail-mpg-d30b-d-gazebo/p/itm5c0036d47fda0?pid=GZBH489FQQR9UCT4&cmpid=product.share.pp&_refid=PP.3da16fcc-c65f-4f72-ab30-ce6c5f4d3f91.GZBH489FQQR9UCT4&_appld=CL) R2250. I prefer this one because it not only provides the top plane for branding, which can be hard to see for people what we have printed there, but 3 out of the 4 sides have a covering which we can brand so it can be easier for people to see our brand.
 - C. Shirts. (<https://silverstartshirts.co.za/product-category/adults/t-shirts/>) This website has plain T-shirts going from R40 to R90 per t-shirt depending on the GSM. I would suggest we get the middle range quality so we don't compromise on quality and how people —and the workers, most especially, that day who will be given the shirts for free and continue marketing for us where- and whenever they wear it again— will perceive our brand if we opt for the cheapest one but neither should we go for the most expensive one because it will be too expensive. (Cost-signaling theory) How much to print/brand a t-shirt?
 - D. Tools to work with (this would have been also a good way of promoting our Tool-hiring feature): refuse bags and gloves (a litter picker is expensive)
 - E. Transportation costs (use my bakkie to carry the equipment). Petrol costs
 - F. How long will it be on that day? This looks into whether we should have snacks for the workers while they are working because we will only give them the money after the task/promo for the day is done, which I can anticipate some workers will complain about being hungry and that the money they are

supposed to get paid is the one they planned buying food with, or they can be told in days advance that they should pack food to eat.

- G. Materials for brand visibility: posters, flyers, speakers? How do we reconcile with the opposing idea of picking up litter but we are putting up posters which are likely going to be litter in the future?
- H. Photo- and videographer (this can also be put as a gig on the platform) We can go to UNISA/TUT/UP and look for students in the Arts faculty to help us shoot and edit it for a negotiated fee. I have searched for professional photo/videographers which so i have found the price for 6hours to be around R9k-R12k (image below). So, not to sound stingy but I think getting students, who would have shown us their previous work, may be cheaper and also give

them something to add on their portfolio

2026 WEDDING PACKAGES





BRONZE *ELOPEMENT (PHOTO ONLY)*

- 4 HOURS
- 200+ EDITS
- ADDITIONAL PHOTOGRAPHER
- ONLINE GALLERY

R 5 000



SILVER *(PHOTO ONLY)*

- 8 HOURS
- 400+ EDITS
- ADDITIONAL PHOTOGRAPHER
- ONLINE GALLERY

R 8 000



GOLD *(PHOTO ONLY)*

- 8 HOURS
- 400+ EDITS
- ENGAGEMENT SESSION
- ADDITIONAL PHOTOGRAPHER
- ONLINE GALLERY

R 9 000



DIAMOND *(PHOTO & FILM)*

- 8 HOURS
- 400+ EDITS
- 3-4 MIN FILM
- ONLINE GALLERY

R 10 500



PLATINUM *(PHOTO & FILM)*

- 8 HOURS
- 500+ EDITS
- 3-4 MIN FILM
- ENGAGEMENT SESSION
- ADDITIONAL PHOTOGRAPHER
- ONLINE GALLERY

R 13 500

- I. Data: to hot-spot people who will say they don't have data to download the app
- J. Should we get inexpensive merchandise to give out to people who download and sign up that day? It would be genius if its something that can be for their phones, because how many times do people pick up their phones, sometimes habitually. So even if its at the back of the phone other people can still see it when they are taking a call or have it facing down.
- K. The reusable items will be the Gazebo. So for every time we go to another location to do the same awareness campaign, we should buy the

non-reusables. And also give the gig to different people and not just the same sets of people, that way we are also increasing the number of on-the-ground marketers

- L. Total: So we have to decide on the number of locations we are going to go to and then multiply the costs of the non-reusables to that.
- M. Location: we will have to always do a research if some venues need municipal/ the owners approval before going there because i know that government owned spaces like public areas; you cant fix or clean up a place without their approval no matter how good the intention is, like Otukile Motshwaedi (Rustenburg) <https://share.google/G1HQB2uPTSNA8Q7d0>. [**(there are actually a lot of individuals who have and are doing this which makes me think, how about we contact them and ask them to be our promoters which could use our platform to get people doing the job with them and their movements?)** (read on the stories of the people who have done this and their obstacles if they ever came across them)]

49. double A, from DAALA, can be our double peace sign sign which is showed upside down to show the double A. Peace sign for peace of mind hiring somebody from our app

- 2 As, we just arent good once, we are twice as good, we are two (too) good
- peace sign
- dueces because the job is done

50. Collab with big artists,, and have them opening up their profiles on the app so that people can easily book them via the platform

51. Approach random people in public and ask them whats one thing they need fixed at home or with their cars, and then make them sign up right there and there, request a gig/ hire one of the workers on the platform and give them a certain price cut using a promo code if not entirely free from their side (the company will pay for it). We will ask afterwards if they can allow us to post this on our socials, but the first thing we should always do is ask if we can record our interaction before we begin. (im reminded of Capitecs initial public launching campaign where they did the same thing and broadcasted these random talks with strangers on television since social media then wasn't as big and people would get super excited by seeing themselves on TV which worked for Capitec because those individuals would mention Capitecs name to their excitement). We should focus **MORE**, not necessarily mainly/only, on "old" mediums of advertising like TV and radio more than social media which is crowded and most likely overpriced because of the demand

52. Takeover the billboards companies have placed outside their facilities with branding and contact details by forming up some agreement with them that can we use our branding (colors and logos) on their billboards and then redesign their billboards with their information and QR codes for people who will want to book them through the app (maybe we can give a discount to the people who use that QR code to book them through the app, so that drives them more customers because people will opt for a discount over normal price and on our side it will increase the downloads, sign ups and usage)
53. host tool shed events where guys, most especially, can bond with each other while building something for their mental health. Record those events to post on your social media. We can use the tool-hiring feature for these events
54. Taking a vacation in a city you dont know or which places to go? Hire a “tour guide” who is really a local who knows his way and places in that area. Yes, there is google maps and internet blogs of good spots but nothing beats the peace of mind that theres a guy who can be your google maps, internet blog suggestion for great spots and photographer to record you and your partner, friends or family ALL-IN-ONE! You can specify your itinerary, for example wanting to go see the townships of Cape Town on the 2nd day of your visit in Cape Town. Basically what im trying to say is that this app can begin to disrupt the Tour Guide and even safari guide sector which will open up regular civilians to do that. Because in all honesty, safari guiding is literally being in a car and seeing the animals for yourself as the guest/tourist, and for the driver you just need good communication/entertainment/performance/public speaking skills, yeah the knowledge of the animals, plants and non-living things is needed but up to a certain point which can be argued if a person cant learn that for themselves and begin driving tourists around and learning on the job without the gatekeeping of having to need certificates to do that. The certified guides can use that as a selling point when they pen their profiles (i have written this on my phones’ note app before, IMPORT IT HERE)
55. I have a friend who sees an opportunity back at home to charge services for cleaning the insides of big Jojo water tanks. That will be added into the app
56. I wanted to do mobile car washing and detailing. That will be added into the app as a valet/ car detailer

57. I have a friend who is enthusiastic about merging his design skills and his love for car speaker sound. That will be added into the app as well as a sound engineer/ customisation design for car interiors

58. Use the popular events of the year as something to market about during those times. E.g during tax filing seasons have ads that promote accountants or people who have the knowledge to do them, from June to before the final matric national exams begin promote tutors to matriculants, during wedding season which is from September to December promote photographers, catering guys, tent guys, sound engineers (you can also have a feature where these professionals can collaborate with one another and offer packages to customers)

59. But why didnt you just Daala it?

60. Catch phrase for ads e.g (*His car broke down on the side of the road on his way to the meeting. [insert catch phrase]. Tax filing season had just arrived, [insert catch phrase]*):

- He/she/they just Daala'd/Daala it. (This one sounds like Nikes "just do it")
- No problem/worries/stress, it was Daala'd?
- He/she/they Daala'd it

61. Do what Nandos does where it uses current events and turns it into comedy. We can use the Madlanga commission to create a skit where the word do is replaced with Daala. The judge asking the person being questioned "okay, we hear you, but why didnt you Daala it? Obviously in these ads we should be creative in seamlessly inserting the call-to-action for using our app like "Why didnt you just Daala it?" or "You know you could have just Daala'd it right?" These skit ads shouldnt really focus on the politics but use the relevancy of the courtroom ,for example if we are going to have one inspired by the Madlanga commission, certain image likeness in dress code and mannerisms for viewers to pick up who we are "trying" to resemble



62.

I love the creativity of this ad. It stands out from the usual flat canvas billboards. We can come up with creative marketing ideas to the many things that aren't working/ not fixed in public. E.g putting a human-like figure in our branding next to a broken traffic light acting as if its fixing it with the tagline "you could have just Daala'd it or They Daala'd it" (Guerilla Marketing). Our own version would be human figures, in that trades commonly known workwear but with a touch of our colors or branding, as toy figures with the tools on their hands. And then the packaging will be in our branding saying for example "let Uncle Sipo Daala it, he is a plumber" and then in students campuses we could have the same but for tutors

63. Approach property agencies to let their tenants know that they can use our platform to hire people to fix small things that dont need the landlord to do it, and also the agencies themselves can hire people from our platform to fix stuff in the building e.g fixing the lift

64. Start with a selected few and then tell them to share to people who they think will need it. Make it seem as if its a secret or exclusive platform, when we know very well that people will most likely tell and share it to other people with the impression that they are knowledgeable and trust the app's value that they are willing to share it with somebody else. Basically how Gmail and Spotify began

65. Ad: Metro Booming 'Am I Dreaming' song. You have an extreme sports guy (a SAN athlete e.g Dallan Goldman) who has a vision of creating a video where the song is

played live by guys who know how to play the instruments found in the song to make his video special while he does what he loves doing (whatever extreme sports e.g freestyle motorcross). So he doesn't know where to begin looking for these people, so he remembers about us and then goes on his phone and in our platform and starts posting a gig requesting the instrument players which in the ad everytime he clicks on the service providers/ instrumental players they pop up already equipped with their instruments, and as he clicks for all the people he needs they pop up (literally out of thin air). The violinist starts playing just as the song starts (the instrument players should be requested and introduced just before the instrument on the song begins playing so they are the ones that perform the song). **You can dream it, or you can Daala it.** I'm still thinking should the part where the rider puts on his helmet just before he begins his stunt should be put before or after the tag line, and should the tag line be spoken or printed across the screen? (remember to also add at the end as if we had forgotten to mention that even the guy recording the video was Daala'd. You can say at literally the very end as the screen dims signaling the end of the ad, it quickly lights up with the guy voice/character/printing saying "oh we almost forgot, also the guy who shot this was Daala'd" where the instrument players have a confused face to what's going on but then quickly go back to playing the ending of the song where this time around it dims out to being the end. Remember the people in this video should be either in our branding or colors and the athlete should show his skills.

66. the celebrity/athlete adverts; have regular folks envisioning an event (e.g a wedding) being performed by their favorite artist. No biggie you can hire that artist through the app. If it's athletes we can have them being the main character of the ads

67. Appear wherever NEWS channels are covering something in the area (but make sure to choose what type of scenes/themes/mood of these NEWS reportings do you want the brand to be associated with, obviously you wouldn't want to appear in death, corruption or negative racial topic scenes). Appear in uniting movements like Springbok fans being covered, a good Samaritan risking their life to save another random stranger (I don't know how we will be always on standby and geared up with our branding to quickly go there 💡 create gigs on the platform by the platform for people to subtly show up in the camera vision of the NEWS reporting wearing our branding, and how we will pay them out is if we can confirm that they were the individuals seen on the NEWS ***with** our branding. This is another way of getting people constantly using and browsing the app, anticipating a fun gig which will be PR for the platform. We could tell them that they should appear sweeping the ground or fixing something (anything that is related to the services our platform offers) Have the mascot pop up where NEWS channels are reporting a broken infrastructure like bursting pipe, where he is in the background in bright colors (we should have a

bright color as part of our brand colors) shaking his head and taking out his phone pretending to be tapping his phone and then next thing actors in our brand colors with tools come from nowhere and pretend to be preparing to fix whatever is being reported

68. AirBnB founders saw an opportunity when they heard Obama was going to have a presidential speech addressing the housing crisis, so they set out to the venue and started getting people to sign up on the platform to host people who would be coming from all over the country to see this event. It was genius because they used the press (and viewership that came from that big event, and also the fact that it was covering a topic that their business was helping to solve. So from there they got coverage from NEWS outlets and garnered awareness and buzz (lol, i swear idea number 66 came before i listened to the podcast of Joe Gebbia on How I Built This podcast, it is honestly a coincidence). So what big political event can we piggyback to get awareness from while literally solving on the ground —talking with people who came to see this event—the topic that will be addressed on that day. It has to be something regarding unemployment, informal sector. It can be done in Political Party rallies (we are in the right are for this since most of them like going to the Union Buildings)

- 💡 **ELECTION DATES** are also good days for us to be there where we address/approach the individuals in these big crowds and use the unemployment topic that has brought people to vote as something that our company seeks to solve

69. Leave advertising material (it would be genius to have pictures of real life mechanics or painters on these materials with a link/QR code to their profile on the platform) on the windshields of cars you notice needs fixing in public parkings (preferably open public parkings, and not closed/in-building public parkings which can be creepy for car owners to know we want that far to promote ourselves)

70. Gautrain PR stunt and advertising. Just like Taxi commuters, most of the people if not all will be our target market

71. Create ads that basically tell single folks (most especially women) that say “if you dont have a man, it aint the end of the world because oom Peter is there to fix your plumbing issues”

72. Do humanitarian acts like giving water to students/residents whenever there are water outages. This will solidify our brand image of being ***for the people and being there to help***

Social media platforms and how you plan to generate awareness in/on them

- **Instagram:** DIYers, handymen, skilled individuals as influencers
- **Facebook:** community groups, car groups, DIY groups
- **Twitter:** hashtags (on what though?), influencers
- **Reddit & Quora:** people asking for help
- **Whatsapp:** community groups, university groups
- **Dating apps?:** Can you be my date for this particular day, i will pay you so much (an actual profile of a real person -pay a matriculant for matric dance or Uni student for a freshers party - on Tinder that has put the link of the gig on their bio) lol this would be crazy and would get people who are on Tinder seeing this profile screenshotting it confused, curious and wanting to share this bizarre thing they are seeing
- **MeetUp:** attend meetings, whether online or in-person, that are (or can be) related to the services your platform offers. I have seen groups there where they have robotics meetings. You could attend them and let them know that they can sell these products on our platform (future feature). Our platform brand could also venture into supporting creatives through funding to create genius products that could be sold to the public. We can also tell them that they could offer their services on our platform to help University students who are building models for their school projects
- **AirBnB hosts:** Contact and ask them if they would be willing to use our platform to hire people on our app to fix stuff in their rental spaces. We could also ask for them to place a card with our branding in their rooms so when guests do come in they can check our platform) we could give these hosts promo codes which their guests could use. Q: So since these guests will be visiting the area for a short period, what services can we highlight to them to use our platform? A: We could promote Kasi guides who could drive them around and show them places. Unlike Uber where the requestor knows where they want to go, our Kasi Guides/ Drivers will be using their knowledge of the area to show them around. Now the other question that pops up from this is: What if the requestors keep on asking to go to more different places

advised by their Kasi Driver, how does the platform charge such a service because you can't know for sure what the locations will be and how long they will take. The solution could be charging at an hourly rate. So once there is a pickup and both customer and service provider accept that they are now in the same car, there can be a timer that calculates by the hourly rate, and then once the trip is over which will be both confirmed by both parties, this could signal the platform to stop the hourly rate fee timer and ask for the buyer to pay that fee. Now that poses another question: wouldn't that now be creating the problem our escrow feature would be trying to solve, where in this case how do we solve the issue of the tourists refusing to pay the driver at the end of the ride? Maybe before the gig is posted, the poster (we should replace the word "poster" with our in-app lingo once we have decided what to call them but the tasker can be called as om/oom Daala or Daaler as in "Do-er" since the word is Daala is Do, so the addition of the "-er" at the end can signify that it's the person doing the job) will have to at least have a place in mind which could be where our platform puts that money in escrow once the task is accepted, and then when they get to that destination, our app can ask both Daaler and poster if they have agreed to go somewhere which would then activate our hourly rate fee timer, adding on top of the initial yet-unreleased amount fee that is supposed to go to the Daaler

Mascot:

Our platform makes it easy to basically outsource everything via the app that is needed in our marketing campaign, including the launch. How cool is that? So for the mascot's mask, we should run a social media campaign asking for designers to design it for us and then the winner gets a prize. I wanted this gig to be done through the app, but then that would take away the competitiveness for many designers to showcase their skills and the chance to create a viral moment from the competition getting more attention/engagement. So this marketing idea should come in the later marketing phases of the platform which will also be a good way to launch the character/mascot

How the character will be formally launched is him seated watching a video of all the media sources cut and pasted into it all talking about unemployment in SA. So this scene will be shot from behind, in a dark room where you can see the silhouette of the character being lit up by the only light in the room which comes from the screen.

One of the many answers we can give to people as they begin asking why the mask, we will tell them he is a superhero whose job is to empower South Africans, and as we all know most Superheroes are regular people at the end, which regular people could be tied to being them. So the person behind the mask is a regular SAn meaning they represent the average SAn

I think giving him a mask doesn't give the impression of him representing a particular group of the many groups and colors of people found in SA. He can literally blend in everywhere and, repeating my last point, represent everybody

What will his entire outfit be? (obviously it must not be formal wearing because that's not who he will be promoting in the beginning but folks who are informal): jumpsuit?

Images: have an image of him where he is running for a call-out with his shirt unbuttoned showcasing the

Mere-exposure effect

Random questions:

What hands-on movements which are aligned to our mission that we could get in contact with and have some sort of deal with them that they use our platform to get people and we offer them discounts or whatever incentive

i was thinking, how about we book a videographer for a full day and then use those hours to not only shoot the public campaign but also 1 ad for social media, a door-door campaign. like basically maximising the hours we have with the hired services to shoot different content?

Brand: Design, Colors, Logos, Slogans, & Mascots

NB: these are just suggestions, so they can still be discussed, changed or edited if needs be.

Design

Animation when opening the app:

1. When you open the app, the name of the app is written from left to right and then the double a morphs into car headlights where one of the As isn't lighting up, where a generic cartoon (representing the owner of the car/ customer) pops up, brings out their phone types or calls and then our mascot comes along from the top of the screen with a cape and then kneels to the car headlight quickly fixes it, and then flies away. The mascot would be representing car mechanics
2. So basically we can have creative ways to turn the first screen into a very short animation show showcasing different trades/ services using the Daala name and our mascot
3. We can have the whole screen start up in green or grass looking from the top view and then the mascot shows up in a lawnmower (from the left side of the screen) and writes Daala by cutting the grass as he goes to the right side of the screen where he vanishes with the lawnmower. We can use our brand colors with this one where the grass will be Green, and as he writes and cuts the grass the results are in Khaki.

Colors

Color combination:

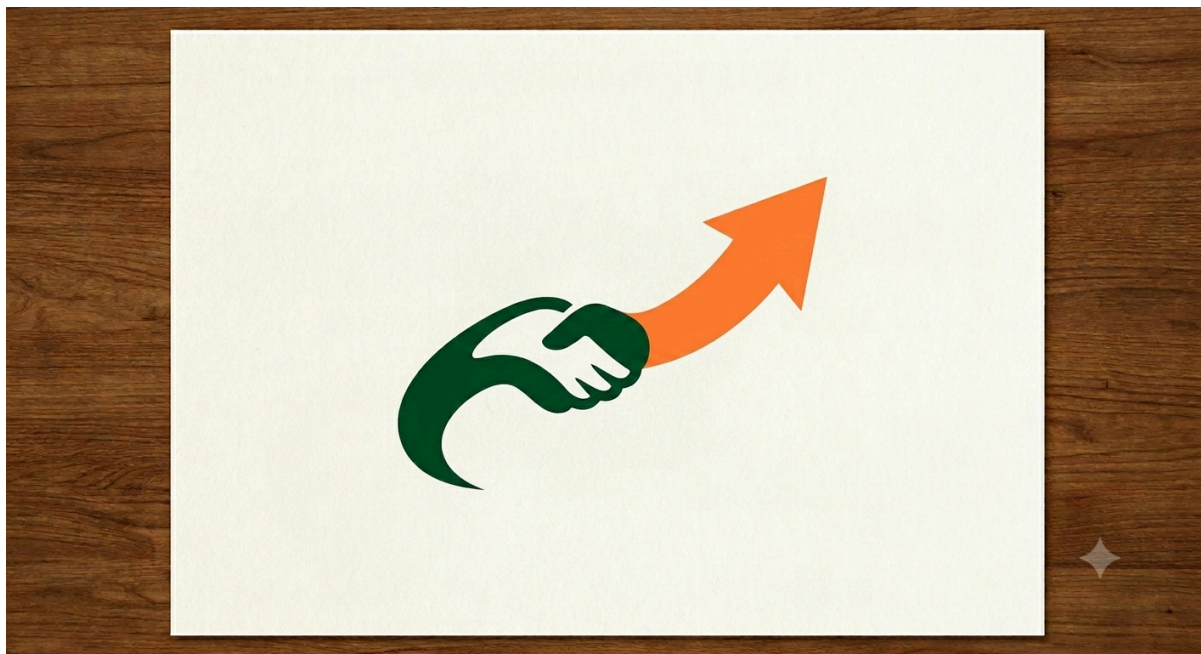
Pack 1:

1.  (HEX: #003716)
2.  (HEX: #FF823A)
3.  (HEX: #F5F5DC)

Logos

Q: What image comes to mind when we think “Do” or “Done” since Daala means ‘Do It’?

A: I was thinking of a checkmark but that would be too close to Nike



Slogans

- *Daala, Daala what you want!*
- *Daala, Daala anything you want!*
- *You can dream it, or you can Daala it*

“Daala what you must” is how the famous expression goes, but we can add a twist to it and say “Daala what you **want**” because anything a person wants can be done through the platform. Or “Daala **anything** you want ekse!” (i can already imagine a colored accent saying that phrase)

Daala, Daala what you ~~must~~ **want!**

OR

Daala, Daala anything you ~~must~~
want!

Mascot

1. Luchador inspired Mask(real life mask that will be worn for guerrilla marketing, and it has to be the same mascot that will be used on the platform and marketing campaigns. The mask itself should have our logo and colors.) Mock ups from Gemini



Observing Competition

Don't focus on the competition, but rather in being **creative and innovative**

*NB: This section is to not get us focusing on our competition, but rather learning from what the competition is doing and how we can create a better product from those observations whether good or bad. Our competition is **Customer Satisfaction and Innovation***

Talk about their social media presence. What type of content do they post on their pages? How often do they post? Do they get any engagements from people there? How many real life people tag and mention their experiences using it?

What sticks out from all of them (so far) and our conclusions

- They lack real life stories and video content from their customers and workers. The closest company that has tried to do this, so far that i've seen, is ProCompare where they have awards which they have given to their workers and posted on their Facebook page (its crazy they thought about the awards thing, because i had the same idea written down in Phase 3 under the Marketing section)
- Influencer/ public profiles collaborations are non-existent
- None of them are known as the industry leader, if known at all, on the national level
- All of them seem to be doing/offering the same thing which is: list workers, list gigs themselves as platforms (all of them seem to be listing them themselves since there arent buyers to do so, so they are "faking it, hoping that they make it" by luring the buyer-side to sign up when they see there is something). We have to rollout the video and tool renting features quickly as something that will make us stand out or else we wont be offering anything different to what is already there

Newcomer overthrowing Incumbent in a crowded market/sector:

- **Apple vs Nokia and Blackberry**
Touchscreen innovation over physical buttons
- **Netflix vs Blockbuster**
Streaming over CDs
- **Google vs Yahoo**
Search engine over

- **Airbnb vs Hospitality Industry**

Giving power to homeowners and removing the fear of letting a stranger in ones home

If I have seen further [than others], it is by standing on the shoulders of giants - Isaac

Newton

Airtasker

Features you love

- Onboarding colorful and creative screen of blending camera taken photos with cartoon tools
- Their profile screen, every detail in there is top class. It literally gives a customer the full information about a worker
 - Ratings and review
 - Jobs count
 - Location
 - Portfolio for customers to **see**, for themselves, your previous jobs and quality of work
- Gig/Trade specific set of options you get when creating a gig
- easy/ seamless witch between Daaler and Poster
- Signing up options of finding out your main purposes for using the app are short/few to choose from, you pick one from Get Things Done or Make Money, and one from as an Individual or Business
- I love how the orange notification color pops out from their primary white background color
- Adding photos as part of creating your gig as the poster
- Providing your budget as part of creating your gig as the poster

Their marketing strategies

- Youtube ads
- Partnered with an F1 team. They placed their branding, not on the cars, but on the pitstop team and toolboxes
- They focus more on traditional/old mediums (TV and Radio) of advertising because it is cheaper than running digital ads which currently everybody is running to subsequently raising the price because of high demand. So they sold stock to channel companies in exchange of running ads, so the deal is structured as a win-win for both where if the channel places them on right timeslots, then that means the company's ads will reach a lot of people getting them to use it more which drives the stock and their shares up. Unlike regular advertising agreements where the company looking to buy ad space is crossing their fingers they get their money's worth while the ad space sellers don't have anything to lose. Also with this

type of contract you can put in it that the company can buy back the stock at whatever fair price its at by that time. This also the same strategy they use to expand into new countries by working with popular TV channel companies from that country

PR stunts they do/did

- Put out a gig for a guy to line up for the latest Apple product at an Apple store. The guy spent 4 days camping outside that the more each day passed the more support he got from the public to the point he was covered on the news and people donated to him gear to make his stay there comfortable

Angie's List/ Just Angi

Listen to podcasts of Angie Hicks (founder)

- started out as a magazine slash neighbourhood newsletter/brochure selling memberships to people so that they could call her business and ask for whatever servicemen they needed
- she got suggestions of tradesmen who she should put on her list from people in the community who already knew them/used them before her business started. She found these tradesmen by going door to door and asking homeowners who they had used before, their contacts and reviews about them. They had people on the ground from a particular local to know the whereabouts of pros and getting their information for them
- she had to go *door to door sell memberships (\$19/year) and ask for reviews. 2 sales per day was a success for her
- marketing tactics: neighbourhood weekly newspapers, NPR/ radio, Home shows
- a customer once called her looking for a ballet instructor who could teach her daughter. She didn't have anybody on her list who offered that service but somehow found the person who could. (Human Google) This makes me think of the vast services we can offer to people, even the rare/ unpopular services.
- Entrepreneur: persevering after the initial high/excitement/optimism of the idea has subsided and riding through the hard part
- there's a lot of ways to get information but a lot of people are willing to pay for quality information
- move from concentrated/ highly-dense area to less populated areas e.g from cities, to towns to townships and to villages
- no matter how great you are as a company you will get negative reviews. a company with some negative reviews over one that has only positive reviews. You learn more from the former than the latter
- **Give a human touch** to a tech company, like talking to a real human being and not a bot. Allow providers/sellers the opportunity to sign-up and call up

the company and talk/chat. Giving people (users and internal workers) accessibility (to talk to the authority or people who can solve a particular problem) to the company gives value to the company. She would set aside 15 minutes per week to talk to pros. 'People like people, more than they like brands'. How are you talking to your customers? Chatbots over humans

- Be incremental in fund-raising rather than once-off, so you take the journey once step at a time with testing and validation as you expand. So funding goes from bootstrapping to friends and family, to more established funding organisations.
- It sounds counterintuitive because you may need the money in the early stages BUT be picky with your first/early investors because they usually play a huge role in those early stages of the company so if your visions don't align and you discover they have already funded your company it may be a problem.
- Knowing where you are (future) going to grow to and that path (infiltrating and expanding into closely related sectors)
- Knowing what you are good at and what you like to do. "Just because you can doesn't mean you should".
- Don't give up on something that works, and always think of what could work next
- They started with members before professionals because they found the pros through the members
- They didn't believe in anonymous reviews. There is no story without the source
- How to handle negative criticisms
- Kitchen renovator who makes dinner for her clients in their new kitchen to experience it (attaching an emotional feel/connection with a client) 💡 😞
- How did they deal with competitors when they started out as the business model became more appealing to others to start the same thing? They stood with their stance on charging both customer and worker rather than what most were doing which were charging the pros and making it free for homeowners. Pros chose Angi because of the customer reviews and advertising option. Angi focused on leads while competitors focused on driving in traffic of customers
-

TASKRABBIT

Listen to podcasts of Leah Solivan/Busque (founder)

VukaWorks

Worker profile doesn't give much detail about the worker

Marketing videos on their Instagram page (thats the one i have checked so far) dont look like quality. We should invest in guys who know how to shoot and edit our videos to be quality. One thing quality of adverts communicates to the customer about your company is that “if you put so much effort in creating this for me to see, then clearly you truly believe that your brand knows what its talking about” (cost-signaling cognitive bias 101) **QUALITY OF VIDEOS**

They also seem to be using the same actors on their videos. Thats fine but how we should do it is try to call different people (request them through our platform as actors, and tag their handles). We will also give exposure to the editors and videographers (basically the whole team behind the camera) that will also show that we are putting our money where our mouth is. Plus for a person viewing our videos it would be nice for them to see that the ‘gigs’ of the actors in our ads arent permanent but different and real people who you can access on our platform. Plus the actors themselves will feel compelled to return the favour for us exposing them and their profile links (using the Reciprocity principle) by freely marketing for us also through word-of-mouth. **COLLABORATING WITH REAL LIFE WORKERS, AND INFLUENCERS, AND ALSO INTERVIEWING EVERY REAL CUSTOMER WHO USED IT WILL BE A GOOD THING FOR US**

I dont like the quality of their app, its literally all Lovable (vibe-coding platform) coded. We should use Airtasker as our standard even for an MVP (this touches on the quality and cost-signaling effect)

A lot of the workers there dont have jobs completed, it literally a handful of workers who have completed jobs. This also helps us to think in more ways how to get people really using this platform and not just downloading it and forgetting about it. (marketing, PRs, — literally anything that will keep us buzzing in the first few months of launch and then from there it will snowball effect) **OUR MARKETING HAS TO BE BIG AND PRECISE**

- Lets approach real people, ask them what needs fixed, tell them we can get them somebody, and use that as a selling point to get them signing up on the platform and that we will give them a discount for the first gig-request. With this approach we will be finding work for the workers to always be on the platform and looking out for jobs (wait a minute, is Vukaworks only a platform for workers to be called and not like ours where even the person who has no skills can surf gig-requests and make money for themselves? I will have to check more on this) and then for customers we will be driving them more into the app and getting them used to it.
 - Update: okay, you can browse through gigs as a random person looking for gigs but the gig cards dont give you anything to contact the poster or take the gig (i will have to set my profile in different locations, see the gigs available and try to win those gigs) because right now currently it looks like

the gigs are just lies and most likely posted by the owners of the apps which arent intended for real work but to get users hopes up

Cirvo_SA

- They dont have a website, im guessing they are still going to launch their app
- They are launching ads asking people to sign up. These ads are getting a little bit of engagement on their comment section and likes on Facebook, on Instagram the very same ad isnt doing as well

Service Pro Link

(<https://www.serviceprolink.co.za/>)

FinderSA.co.za

(Instagram handle: Findersa_official)

PettyWorx

<https://www.pettyworx.co.za/>

ProCompare.co.za

They have a lot of followers and engagement on their facebook page, but their Instagram hasnt been active/osting for 2 years now

ProMatch

promatchwork.com

Tried it out and the process was less shorter than Bark Market

The other positive thing about the workers there is that as soon as i posted the gig, the guys called me directly within less than 5 minutes. (we have to poach these workers, but first we have to ask what do they like about this particular platform that makes them that quick to respond to a gig)

What i dont fully like is that they seem to send the gig to a certain number of individuals from that area which in my experience were 5 contacts which 2 of them were titled as construction business names (it may be possible that its actually one guy who is presenting

himself as their business — there are upsides to that, but so are downsides where somebody looking to get a small task done will most likely lean into working with an individual rather than a “company”

Trustpilot and Helopeter ratings are good

WorkConnectorsClub

<https://workconnectors.co.za/>

ProFixerSA

<https://www.profixer.co.za/>

TheHandyMan App

<https://thehandymanapp.co.za/>

Bark.mrkt

<https://www.bark.com/en/za/>

Alongside with ProCompare, they are really pushing and serious about it (gig based marketplace) judging from Helopeters reviews

Quickly went over their website to see how easy and legit are they, and they aren't easy at all. They do that trick where they get you filling out details of the gig to get the person you need, and then before you see the list of workers, you are told to sign-up

It looks like it's for businesses rather than individuals who want to make a quick buck. How do we plan to change the minds of informal workers that they can use our platform to find work through

I will still go through it properly to see what good and bad are they doing

BidForGigsSA

<https://bidforgigs.co.za/>

Upnet

Upnet.co.za

ZestPro

Zoo Digital

app.pluginpro.co.za

[ClicknDone.co.za](#)

Their UI is tops. It has a quality look and feel to it

Liquid glass navigation tab/bar

MyQuickJobs

BrandItZa

Will Be Handy

The "**trough of sorrow**" is a term coined by Y Combinator co-founder Paul Graham to describe the painful, exhausting phase a startup or new project goes through. It occurs right after the initial excitement of launching wears off, before the business or initiative achieves real traction. [[1](#), [2](#), [3](#), [4](#), [5](#)]

Key Characteristics of the Trough

- The Dip in Morale: The initial burst of media attention, early adopters, and hype fades. The project looks less glamorous, and progress feels incredibly slow. [[1](#), [2](#)]
- The Hunt for Product-Market Fit: Teams often spend this phase desperately trying to figure out what their customers actually want, leading to self-doubt and pivoting. [[1](#), [2](#), [3](#), [4](#)]
- Mental Fatigue & Stress: With dwindling funds, burnout, and constant pressure to succeed, this period tests the grit and resilience of the founders. [[1](#), [2](#), [3](#), [4](#), [5](#)]

How to Survive It

- Focus on Small Wins: Break down massive goals into tiny, achievable milestones to boost team morale.
- Talk to Your Users: Rather than guessing, lean into the small core group of customers who genuinely love the product and ask for their feedback.
- Extend Your Runway: Strictly manage cash flow and resources to buy yourself enough time to find market fit. [[1](#), [2](#), [3](#), [4](#)]